

SAT Reading & Writing

Transitions 1

Question #	ID		Answer
1.1	20733eac	It has long been thought that humans first crossed a land bridge into the Americas approximately 13,000 years ago. _____ based on radiocarbon dating of samples uncovered in Mexico, a research team recently suggested that humans may have arrived more than 30,000 years ago—much earlier than previously thought. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. As a result, B. Similarly, C. However, D. In conclusion,	C
1.2	f07570bb	Researchers believe that pieces of hull found off Oregon's coast are from a Spanish cargo ship that was lost in 1697. Stories passed down among the area's Confederated Tribes of Siletz Indians support this belief. _____ Siletz stories describe how blocks of beeswax, an item the ship had been carrying, began washing ashore after the ship was lost. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. For this reason, B. For example, C. However, D. Likewise,	B
1.3	01c8c433	Before the 1847 introduction of the US postage stamp, the cost of postage was usually paid by the recipient of a letter rather than the sender, and recipients were not always able or willing to pay promptly. _____ collecting this fee could be slow and arduous, and heaps of unpaid-for, undeliverable mail piled up in post offices. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. Regardless, B. On the contrary, C. Consequently, D. For example,	C
1.4	db8fe023	A potter choosing which type of clay to use for a piece considers two key factors: the desired look of the piece and its intended use. _____ earthenware clay is often used for decorative pieces because of its rustic look. This type of clay is not often used in industrial settings, though, because it is less durable than other clays. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. In other words, B. Regardless, C. In conclusion, D. For example,	D
1.5	04ad68ca	In Gothic architecture, flying buttresses are large arches that help support a building's exterior walls. Before the Gothic era, cathedrals' heavy ceilings had to be supported by thick, short walls, but the invention of flying buttresses eliminated this need. _____ Gothic cathedrals could be built with thinner, higher walls. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. Similarly, B. For instance, C. Nevertheless, D. As a result,	D

SAT Reading & Writing

Transitions 1

Question #	ID		Answer
1.6	fc2bcc79	Tyrian purple was a highly prized dye among the Phoenicians (an ancient civilization located in present-day Lebanon). The Phoenicians were famous for using this natural dye to color their clothes a distinctive purple. _____ the name “Phoenicia” itself, some historians claim, may have originally meant “land of purple.” Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. In fact, B. Regardless, C. Lastly, D. On the contrary,	A
1.7	1b219d14	As a young historian in the 1950s, Alixa Naff began interviewing fellow Arab American immigrants about their experiences straddling two cultures. Over the next few decades, Naff conducted more than 450 such interviews, also known as oral histories. _____ she collected photographs and other artifacts that represented her subjects’ experiences. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. In other words, B. On the contrary, C. In addition, D. Today,	C
1.8	47547d07	In June, female loggerhead sea turtles will swim back to the sandy beaches where they were born to lay eggs of their own. First, the turtle will dig her nest in the sand. _____ she will lay up to 100 eggs in the nest. Finally, she will cover it all with sand, before returning to the ocean. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. By contrast, B. Similarly, C. Next, D. For example,	C
1.9	b7571c0a	Practical movie effects, such as the use of actual locations in a film, provide a more realistic visual experience than computer-generated imagery (CGI) does, but giving audiences the “real thing” can be prohibitively expensive. _____ many filmmakers use a blended approach, employing practical effects whenever possible and CGI elements as necessary to control costs. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. Similarly, B. For this reason, C. Furthermore, D. In other words,	B
1.10	0ee64efc	In the 1850s, William Still was instrumental in helping nearly 1,000 people escape from slavery, earning him the moniker “the Father of the Underground Railroad.” _____ despite the fame of his contributions during his lifetime, Still is discussed far less today than other prominent Black abolitionists from his era, such as Frederick Douglass and Harriet Tubman. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. For example, B. However, C. Specifically, D. Similarly,	B

SAT Reading & Writing

Transitions 1

Question #	ID		Answer
1.11	63c73b50	In 2018, Kurt Luther and Vikram Mohanty created the web-based tool Civil War Photo Sleuth (CWPS). A user uploading an unknown Civil War soldier's photograph to CWPS first tags the photo with all known information. _____ CWPS's facial-recognition software analyzes twenty-seven different physical features and looks for matches to tagged images already in the database. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. Then, B. In fact, C. Likewise, D. For example,	A
1.12	3831f2d7	Arkansas aviator Louise Thaden was already a record breaker when she won the inaugural National Women's Air Derby, a race from California to Ohio, in August of 1929. _____ in December of 1928, Thaden had set an aviation record when she reached an altitude of 20,269 feet in a Travel Air biplane. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. Earlier, B. However, C. Next, D. As a result,	A
1.13	2b5e0731	With darkness falling, a mother elephant loses sight of her calf and wants to make sure it is safe. _____ she releases an infrasonic call for the calf to hear. Infrasonic sound is below the range of human hearing, but many animals can hear these sounds from several miles away. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. For example, B. For this reason, C. Nowadays, D. Similarly,	B
1.14	1c36e3e1	The number of dark spots that appear on the Sun, known as sunspots, can vary greatly. For example, there were about 180 sunspots in November 2001. _____ there were only about 2 sunspots in December 2008. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. In other words, B. Similarly, C. Therefore, D. By comparison,	D
1.15	ac8eb085	"O2 Arena," an award-winning science fiction story by Nigerian author Oghenechovwe Donald Ekpeki, takes place in an alternate version of Nigeria where breathable air is a rare commodity that is owned and sold by companies. _____ people must purchase it with currency called O2 credits. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. As a result, B. In any case, C. Nevertheless, D. Earlier,	A

SAT Reading & Writing

Transitions 1

Question # ID

Answer

1.16 37957752

As biologist Terrie Williams has documented, deep dives present a challenge for seals and other marine mammals. A seal must exert enough energy to propel itself hundreds of meters downward, while keeping its heart rate low enough that it doesn't run out of oxygen while underwater. _____ a seal moves its flippers as little as possible on a deep dive, gliding to conserve energy.

C

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A. In the first place,
- B. On the other hand,
- C. For this reason,
- D. In comparison,

1.17 90117366

To explore how blinking affects social interactions, Dutch researchers observed interactions between human speakers and "listeners" (animated human faces on a screen). The researchers found that when the listeners blinked slowly, the speakers tended to talk for less time. _____ quicker blinks were associated with longer talking times.

D

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A. For example,
- B. Specifically,
- C. Firstly,
- D. By contrast,

1.18 4154a7a3

In 1891, dancer and choreographer Loie Fuller first performed her celebrated Serpentine Dance, artfully twirling her long, flowing skirt to create striking visual effects. _____ in 1896, cinema pioneers Auguste and Louis Lumière made a groundbreaking short film of Fuller's dance.

C

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A. However,
- B. In conclusion,
- C. Later,
- D. In other words,

1.19 d3898d32

Riley Black—the author of critically acclaimed books such as *My Beloved Brontosaurus* (2013)—is best known for writing about dinosaurs, but she has also conducted hands-on fieldwork. _____ her fieldwork has included paleontological digs in Utah, Montana, and Wyoming, and her dinosaur fossil discoveries can be seen at places such as the Carnegie Museum of Natural History.

C

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A. Regardless,
- B. Subsequently,
- C. Specifically,
- D. Conversely,

1.20 6916c8e5

Laetitia Ky's hair is her art. Inspired by hairstyles from various African tribes, the Ivorian artist uses wire and thread to sculpt her hair into all kinds of shapes. _____ she once made her hair into the shape of the continent of Africa—including the island of Madagascar!

C

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A. Soon,
- B. Elsewhere,
- C. For example,
- D. However,

SAT Reading & Writing

Transitions 1

Question #	ID		Answer
1.21	de0bcf4f	Spanish surrealist Oscar Dominguez, like many of his contemporaries, wanted to incorporate elements of chance and randomness in his artistic process. _____ he employed techniques that produced random, unpredictable results, such as decalcomania, which involved pressing a blank canvas onto a paint-covered surface to generate abstract patterns. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. With this in mind, B. On the contrary, C. In conclusion, D. Regardless,	A
1.22	b5a399f1	Following the Mata Ortiz pottery technique, Mexican sculptor Juan Quezada Celado starts by creating the base of the pot with a slab of clay. _____ he builds the pot walls by layering coils of clay around the perimeter of the base. Celado then smooths out the pot's walls with a hacksaw blade. At last, the pot is ready to be painted. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. For example, B. However, C. By contrast, D. Next,	D
1.23	bfb4e85e	Ballet dancer Misty Copeland has accomplished a lot. She has appeared on Broadway, toured with Prince, and even served on the President's Council on Sports, Fitness & Nutrition. _____ according to Copeland, nothing in her career matches the honor of being the first African American woman named principal dancer at the prestigious American Ballet Theatre. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. Thus, B. However, C. For example, D. Second of all,	B
1.24	c4f7f726	Many butterfly species have bold, brightly colored wings. _____ some butterfly species have wings that are almost completely colorless and transparent. Glasswing butterflies, for example, have see-through wings that make them nearly invisible. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. Similarly, B. Previously, C. In other words, D. However,	D
1.25	e965fd73	Preston Singletary is a Tlingit glass artist who often collaborates with other artists. _____ he has worked with Tewa pottery artist Jody Naranjo several times. Together, Singletary and Naranjo have created pottery-inspired glass pieces such as <i>Sunset Stampede</i> and <i>Kiva Steps</i>. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. In conclusion, B. For example, C. However, D. In comparison,	B

SAT Reading & Writing

Transitions 1

Question #	ID		Answer
1.26	d10e46a2	The ancient Spartans were known for their bitinglly concise—or laconic—wit, a quality they maintained even in the face of great peril. _____ when Philip II of Macedon threatened Laconia (the region of Greece containing Sparta), he said, "If I invade Laconia, I shall turn you out." The Spartans replied with a single word: "If." Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. Rather, B. In other words, C. That said, D. For instance,	D
1.27	7f20374f	The 435 state districts in the US House of Representatives are designed to be roughly equal in population. These districts average around 760,000 people in size. However, only about 730,000 people live in the state of Alaska. _____ Alaska has just one House district, encompassing the entire state. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. As a result, B. Instead, C. Finally, D. For instance,	A
1.28	f33f0892	Although novels and poems are considered distinct literary forms, many authors have created hybrid works that incorporate elements of both. Bernardine Evaristo's <i>The Emperor's Babe</i>, _____ is a verse novel, a book-length narrative complete with characters and a plot but conveyed in short, crisp lines of poetry rather than prose. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. by contrast, B. consequently, C. secondly, D. for example,	D
1.29	c78620ba	In 1968, US Congressman John Conyers introduced a bill to establish a national holiday in honor of Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. The bill didn't make it to a vote, but Conyers was determined. He teamed up with Shirley Chisholm, the first Black woman to be elected to Congress, and they resubmitted the bill every session for the next fifteen years. _____ in 1983, the bill passed. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. Instead, B. Likewise, C. Finally, D. Additionally,	C
1.30	660d50dc	Samuel Coleridge-Taylor was a prominent classical music composer from England who toured the US three times in the early 1900s. The child of a West African father and an English mother, Coleridge-Taylor emphasized his mixed-race ancestry. For example, he referred to himself as Anglo-African. _____ he incorporated the sounds of traditional African music into his classical music compositions. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. In addition, B. Actually, C. However, D. Regardless,	A

SAT Reading & Writing

Transitions 1

Question #	ID		Answer
1.31	87d8a2ff	During a 2021 launch, Rocket Labs' Electron rocket experienced an unexpected failure: its second-stage booster shut down suddenly after ignition. _____ instead of downplaying the incident, Rocket Labs' CEO publicly acknowledged what happened and apologized for the loss of the rocket's payload, which had consisted of two satellites. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. Afterward, B. Additionally, C. Indeed, D. Similarly,	A
1.32	a6155e60	Every chemical compound has a spectroscopic fingerprint, a pattern of reflected light unique to that compound. _____ upon analyzing the light reflected by the bright regions on the surface of the dwarf planet Ceres, Maria Cristina De Sanctis of Rome's National Institute of Astrophysics was able to determine that the regions contain large amounts of the compound sodium carbonate. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. Regardless, B. Meanwhile, C. Thus, D. In comparison,	C
1.33	420dea42	A blend of gabardine and wool, the material for Elvis Presley's Gold Vine jumpsuit was flexible enough to allow the singer to perform his signature dance moves. _____ the added weight of the suit's swirling vines made of gold rhinestones likely limited Elvis's mobility to some degree. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. For this reason, B. Firstly, C. However, D. In other words,	C
1.34	b5972710	Niger ratified the Outer Space Treaty, an international agreement with over 100 signing nations that acts as the foundation for the laws of space, on February 1, 1967. Jordan, _____ has yet to officially ratify the treaty; it only signed it. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. in contrast, B. specifically, C. for example, D. similarly,	A
1.35	56336696	When using sumac for dyeing cloth, textile artists first soak it in water to release its color. Then, they add the cloth to the dyebath and simmer it for hours, perhaps even days. _____ they will remove the cloth, at which point it will have turned a vibrant red color. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. Nevertheless, B. Likewise, C. Eventually, D. In other words,	C

SAT Reading & Writing

Transitions 1

Question #	ID		Answer
1.36	49ecf985	On March 3, 1991, Switzerland's government lowered the minimum voting age for its citizens from 20 to 18 years old. _____ many people in Switzerland gained a new opportunity to participate in their country's political process. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. Nevertheless, B. As a result, C. By contrast, D. Similarly,	B
1.37	fc5e83cc	When following musical scores, professional opera singers like soprano Ana María Martínez take vocal directions from descriptive notations, typically in Italian, that appear alongside the musical notes. _____ these descriptive terms might guide the performer to sing <i>giocoso</i> (playfully) or <i>lento</i> (at a slow tempo). Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. On the other hand, B. All the same, C. For example, D. In the second place,	C